

# RAJ CHOPRA

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Corporate Development and Strategic Finance leader with 15+ years of experience sourcing, evaluating, and integrating acquisitions across technology, software, and financial services sectors. Proven record of driving platform expansion and enterprise value creation through disciplined M&A, strategic partnerships, and post-acquisition integration. Experienced in working directly with founders, executives, and private equity sponsors to build repeatable acquisition frameworks and long-term growth strategies.

Areas of expertise: Mergers & Acquisitions (M&A) | Corporate Development | Deal Sourcing & Execution | Financial Modeling & Valuation | Strategic Partnerships | Growth Strategy | Post-Merger Integration | Business Case Development | Cross-Functional Leadership

Technical: Excel | PowerPoint | AI Python Development (coursework) | VBA (coursework) | AI Prompt Engineering (coursework) | HTML

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### ROYAL BANK OF CANADA (RBC), Toronto, ON

#### Director – Corporate Development (2024 – 2025)

#### Associate Director – Corporate Development (2022 – 2024)

Directed cross-functional deal teams on strategic transactions, partnerships, and divestitures, supporting enterprise transformation priorities across global business lines. Developed frameworks for inorganic growth assessments, due diligence, and post-transaction governance.

- Directed the structuring and execution of a landmark strategic loyalty partnership with a major Canadian retailer, including financial modeling, due diligence management, legal negotiation, and Board-level approvals.
- Led the divestiture of a non-core loan portfolio to a fintech lender, driving the strategic repositioning toward core business lines. Managed financial analysis, internal governance, cross-functional alignment, and transaction execution.

### MONERIS SOLUTIONS, Toronto, ON

#### Director – Corporate Development & Strategy (2020 – 2022)

#### Manager – Corporate Development & Strategy (2018 – 2020)

Oversaw a Corporate Development team responsible for M&A, strategic partnerships, and direct investments. Led development of corporate strategy initiatives and cross-functional growth projects across new products, innovation, and market expansion.

- Led end-to-end acquisition of UEAT, a SaaS restaurant ordering platform, expanding Moneris' merchant solutions ecosystem and enhancing its recurring revenue base. Delivered ahead of target completion date with strong strategic alignment to Moneris' growth roadmap.
- Originated and executed a strategic investment in Bookmark, an AI-powered website builder, supporting product diversification and digital enablement initiatives to expand Moneris' merchant solutions portfolio.

### VERTICALSCOPE, Toronto, ON

#### Director – Corporate Development (2017 – 2018)

Led acquisition strategy and execution for digital media assets valued between \$5M – \$50M. Directed due diligence, financial modeling, legal structuring, and integration planning for acquired businesses. Participated in capital raising initiatives and provided operational leadership to acquired units.

- Sourced, structured, and closed the acquisition of FIT Group, a network of fitness review websites, resulting in a 50% EBITDA increase post-integration.
- Managed operational turnaround of the fitness affiliate marketing vertical, implementing new SEO strategies and content initiatives that drove a 30% increase in monthly traffic.

**DEFINITY FINANCIAL (FORMERLY ECONOMICAL INSURANCE), Toronto, ON****Manager – Corporate Development (2016 – 2017)**

Led assessment, diligence, and execution of strategic equity and debt investments in Canadian insurance brokerages. Supported portfolio performance management across multiple investments.

- Developed and presented complex financial models and transaction recommendations to executive leadership and Board, supporting over \$100M in closed transactions.

**VERTICALSCOPE, Toronto, ON****Acquisitions Specialist – Corporate Development (2013 – 2016)**

Executed over 50 private acquisitions of digital media assets valued between <\$1M – \$10M across automotive, outdoors, health, and technology verticals. Built direct sourcing pipeline of founder-led businesses; managed full lifecycle from initial contact through integration.

- Led operational management and growth strategy for RateMDs.com, including strategic planning, identifying new business opportunities, and prioritization of all development initiatives, achieving over 100% increase in annual recurring revenue.
- Delivered targeted operational improvements across acquired businesses, enhancing user engagement, SEO performance, and monetization.

**PUBLIC MOBILE, Toronto, ON****Associate – Strategy & Business Development (2010 – 2011)**

Supported C-suite and senior leadership in planning and executing corporate strategy, M&A initiatives, and strategic partnerships across the telecommunications sector.

**BMO CAPITAL MARKETS, Toronto, ON & Vancouver, BC****Analyst – Investment Banking (2008 – 2010)**

Performed financial analysis, strategic due diligence, complex financial modelling and market assessments relating to the execution of M&A transactions across technology, mining, forestry and real estate sectors.

**EDUCATION**

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**Western University – Richard Ivey School of Business, London, ON****Master of Business Administration – MBA (2012)**

- Completed capstone research project on the “Growth of the National Basketball Association (NBA) in India”.

**Bachelor of Arts, Honors Business Administration – HBA (2007)****INTERESTS**

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Emerging technology (AI, fintech, platforms) | Global investment and market trends | Cooking and exploring new recipes | Geopolitics and macroeconomics | True crime podcasts and documentaries